

SAVIOUR'S MODEL PARISH
YOUTH SUNDAY

THE CALL OF DESTINY

JEREMIAH 1:5-8

MINISTER JOE AKAGWE

SUNDAY ✦ **19** ✦ JULY 2026

THE CALL OF DESTINY

Youth Sunday • Saviour's Model Parish • Minister Joe Akagwe • Sunday, 19 July 2026

JEREMIAH 1:5-8

"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I sanctified you; I ordained you a prophet to the nations. Then said I: Ah, Lord God! behold, I cannot speak: for I am a child. But the Lord said unto me, Say not, I am a child: for thou shalt go to all that I shall send thee, and whatsoever I command thee thou shalt speak. Be not afraid of their faces: for I am with thee to deliver thee, saith the Lord."

Introduction: You Were Pre-Programmed

Every life carries a design. Before you were formed, before you took your first breath, God had already ordained a course for you. You have been pre-programmed for a purpose that did not begin with you and does not end with you. This is destiny — not a vague sense of potential, but a specific assignment placed on your life by God Himself.

But here is the sobering truth: not everyone who is destined for something actually fulfills that destiny. Destiny is not automatic. It is not inherited passively, and it does not unfold on its own. Many carry the seed of a great calling and never see it flower, because fulfilling destiny requires cooperation with the God who authored it.

IT IS NOT EVERYBODY THAT IS DESTINED THAT FULFILLS DESTINY.

Three Movements of God Toward You

Before destiny can be walked out, three things must first be true of your relationship with God:

- God knew you — He was aware of you before your existence began.
- God sanctified you — He set you apart for a specific, holy purpose.
- God ordained you — He commissioned and authorized you for the assignment.

No one can fulfill destiny without first knowing God. This is the non-negotiable starting point. You cannot walk in what God has planned for you while remaining a stranger to Him. Destiny flows out of relationship, not the other way around.

This means the first step is not striving for greatness — it is pursuing a personal relationship with God. When that relationship is real, He does the rest: He sanctifies you, setting you apart, and He ordains you, releasing you into your assignment.

The Two Sides of Destiny: Priest and King

Destiny has two dimensions, and both must be present for it to be fulfilled:

- The Priest — this is your life with God: your devotion, your intimacy, your walk before Him in private.
- The King — this is your influence with people: the impact, authority, and leadership you carry among those around you.

A person may carry great influence in the world (king) but have no depth with God (priest) — and that influence will eventually be hollow or destructive. Equally, a person may have deep devotion to God but exert no influence in their sphere — and destiny remains unfulfilled. To fulfill destiny, you must function as both priest and king: rooted in God, and released in impact.

Good Success: Known by God, Known by Works

MATTHEW 5:16

"Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven."

Good success is this: a man or woman who is known by God and whose life is marked by good works. It is not success measured only by visibility or achievement, but success that has both a vertical dimension (known by God) and a horizontal dimension (good works that point others to Him).

There is a part reserved for you in this story — a portion of the assignment that only you can fulfill. Consider this picture: the moment a baby is born, the baby is cleaned up and bathed before anything else happens. In the same way, God cleans you up before He hands you a destiny. Purification comes before commissioning.

Consecration: The Samson Pattern

JUDGES 13:4-5

"Now therefore beware, I pray thee, and drink not wine nor strong drink, and eat not any unclean thing: for, lo, thou shalt conceive, and bear a son; and no razor shall come on his head: for the child shall be a Nazarite unto God from the womb: and he shall begin to deliver Israel out of the hand of the Philistines."

Samson is our case study in consecration. Before he was born, he was already set apart as a Nazarite — consecrated to the Lord for a specific purpose. His strength and calling were tied directly to his consecration.

As believers, we too must know our consecration. You have been set apart. This means there are things you must refuse to join others in, however normal or attractive they may appear — indulgences

such as alcohol and womanizing that dilute or destroy a consecrated life. Knowing your consecration means knowing what you have been separated from, and what you have been separated for.

Daniel: Resolute and Prayerful

Daniel gives us a second case study. In a foreign palace, surrounded by pressure to conform, Daniel refused to defile himself with the king's meat. He drew a clear line and held it — not out of legalism, but out of resolve to remain consecrated in a compromising environment.

Daniel was also prayerful and resolute in his service to God. His consecration was not just a list of refusals — it was sustained by a devoted prayer life and a steady, faithful service that did not waver under pressure. This combination — resolve plus prayer plus service — is what preserved his destiny through hostile circumstances.

Preserving Destiny: A Word on Marriage

PROVERBS 31:2-7

"What, my son? and what, the son of my womb? and what, the son of my vows? Give not thy strength unto women, nor thy ways to that which destroyeth kings. It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink: Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted. Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts. Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more."

Proverbs 31 carries a strong emphasis on how destiny is preserved, and marriage is one of the clearest tests of this. The choice of a spouse can either safeguard or sabotage a God-given destiny.

- As a woman, marry a man whose head is God — not merely a person of moral value, but one who is genuinely submitted to God as his authority.
- As a man, marry a woman who fears God — whose reverence for God shapes her character and her home.

Moral value alone is not sufficient grounds for marriage. A person can be moral, kind, and admirable by human standards and still not have God as the head of their life. The question that preserves destiny is deeper: who or what governs this person's decisions?

The Next Step After Consecration: You Are Deployed

JEREMIAH 1:5-6, NLT

The New Living Translation of Jeremiah 1:5-6 makes it plain that God has made you a spokesman. Consecration is not the end goal — it is preparation for deployment. Once you are set apart, you are sent.

This deployment is to change your world. Wherever you are right now — your school, your workplace, your family, your community — is not incidental. It is a deployment. You are stationed there on assignment.

As salt and light, you are called to answer the issues of the nation. This is a high calling: not to withdraw from the problems around you, but to be positioned as the answer to them.

Be a Problem Solver

Destiny is fulfilled by those willing to be problem solvers. Do not run away from challenges — challenges are frequently the very doorway into your assignment. The size of the problem you are willing to engage often reveals the size of the destiny you carry.

Vision Gives Direction

You must have the capacity to see vision. Vision is what gives direction to a life; without it, effort has no clear aim. If God is going to use you significantly, He will carry you toward a big problem — because big assignments are hidden inside big problems.

The Warning: Do Not Fear

JEREMIAH 1:7-8

"But the Lord said unto me, Say not, I am a child: for thou shalt go to all that I shall send thee, and whatsoever I command thee thou shalt speak. Be not afraid of their faces: for I am with thee to deliver thee, saith the Lord."

The final and most urgent word is this: do not fear. Fear is the single greatest obstacle standing between a person and the fulfillment of their destiny. God's response to every excuse of inadequacy is the same assurance He gave the prophet: whatever He sends you to do, He will equip you to say and to do — and He Himself will be present to deliver you.

DO NOT BE AFRAID OF THEIR FACES, FOR I AM WITH YOU TO DELIVER YOU.

Closing Reflection

You have been known, sanctified, and ordained. You carry both the priesthood of intimacy with God and the kingship of influence in your world. Your consecration is not restriction for its own sake — it is the preservation of the very destiny God has assigned to you. And now, having been set apart, you are

deployed: sent as salt and light, as a problem solver, as a spokesman to your generation. Walk in it without fear, for the God who called you has promised to be with you to deliver you.